

Motivation Statement

Jeremy Chia, *for Forward College*

Dear Dr. Latiff,

I strive to live intentionally - aspiring to make an impact.

This impact grows when I help others think clearly about problems. It goes beyond solving problems myself. That insight came gradually - first, while mentoring junior analysts at Turlane, then more sharply at ReDI School of Digital Integration, where I worked with career changers who arrived uncertain whether they belonged in data. The moments I often return to are those when a student makes a quantitative answer with certainty, grounded in frameworks and statistical tests. The feedback loop - seeing where the confidence carries these students - is what I find genuinely motivating about teaching.

My gripe with much of academic education is that we are not intentional enough about establishing relevance. Concepts are taught in isolation from the reality students will walk into. Forward College's pedagogy is designed against that failure. I appreciate that students arrive prepared and come ready to be challenged - this helps them discover how they learn best, preparing them for a lifetime of learning new things. Weekly tutorials and a smaller seminar group make the teaching relationship more personal - there is no hiding behind aggregate performance, and it allows the Fellow to assess where the gaps are. These students are culturally diverse, socially aware, and constantly challenged to do better for the society around them.

The positive leadership mission - preparing people to act on the world's hardest problems - is the right framing for why analytics education matters at all, and it is the answer to why relevance cannot be an afterthought. The four intelligences framing is not decorative - I believe it describes what is needed to produce a defensible recommendation under uncertainty, which is cognitive, practical, and social all at once.

ST2187's content, focusing on decision-making under uncertainty using statistical methods, is designed to give students powerful tools for making sense of what they do not yet know. My vision is to make the 22-week arc feel like a single coherent argument rather than a sequence of disconnected topics, anchored in projects students can engage with immediately. I envision them exploring data topics which matter to them.

For example:

Where should I live? - using Berlin's Rental Prices

- Descriptive statistics reveal what the rental market actually looks like - distributions of price by district, size, and building age that often contradict received wisdom.
- Regression asks what actually predicts rent: is Mitte expensive because it is central, or because flats there are newer and larger?
- Hypothesis testing asks whether the price gap between two districts is real or noise.
- Time series shows how rents have moved and whether the trend is likely to continue.
- Monte Carlo models the budget risk if rents rise by another 10% before the lease ends.

What should I eat? - Using Open Food Fact's ingredients data

- Regression asks whether price predicts nutritional quality, or whether that is an assumption.
- Optimisation finds the most nutritious basket within a budget constraint.
- Monte Carlo models what happens to that basket when food prices shift.

I would also like students to translate their findings into valuable content - providing actionable recommendations. Part of this can be sharing their findings on social media, which builds their confidence and portfolio. This helps them find their voice and puts a practical outcome to learning theoretical statistics concepts - and it is precisely what Forward College's practical intelligence pillar calls for: digital fluency and self-efficacy built through doing, not just through learning.

My grounding as an accountant-turned-data practitioner gives me a dual fluency for this course. Forward College's students are being primed for leadership in complex environments. The gap between knowing a formula and trusting oneself to act on its output is the gap I was trained, by professional experience, to bridge. I would work closely with the LSE material to deliver those components rigorously. I am Berlin-based, hold German permanent residence, and am available for the semester starting September 2026.

Best regards,

Jeremy Chia
Berlin, May 2026